VICTORIA FISHER

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GitHub
Creative Portfolio

EDUCATION

PhD, Epidemiology University of Pittsburgh (Aug 2026 – anticipated May 2030)
Advisor: Dr. Tamara Dubowitz, ScD
Areas of focus/interest: Neighborhood change, cognitive aging and population neuroscience, life course epidemiology, stress, embodiment, menopause

MPH, Epidemiology University of Michigan (Sept 2021 - April 2023)
Thesis: "Association of neighborhood segregation and epigenetic age in older American adults"
Advisors: Dr. Kelly Bakulski, PhD, Dr. Margaret Hicken, PhD, MPH
GPA: 3.99/4

- Through multivariate regression, conducted a cross-sectional analysis of the relationship between residential racial segregation clustering and epigenetic age acceleration in a subset of nationally representative older American adults.
- This research fills a gap in the literature exploring neighborhood segregation as a proxy for structural racism and its relationship to epigenetic ageing, as an indicator of health inequity.
- Worked with two research groups to align thesis analysis with grant and publication requirements.

BS, Marketing; BA, Fine Arts Boston College (Aug 2013 - May 2017)
GPA: 3.5/4

- Double major in marketing (strategic brand management) and fine arts (photography/digital design)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Student Research Assistant Sept 2026 to Present
University of Pittsburgh
PIs: Tamara Dubowitz, ScD; Andi Rosso, PhD
ThinkPHRESH

- Cognitive performance adjudication data collation.
- Manuscript assistance as needed.
- Collection of all development and investment in Hill District and Homewood neighborhoods since 2021.

Research Associate May 2023 to Present
Michigan State University (remote, part-time since Sep '26)
PI: Richard Sadler, PhD, MPH

- Research associate tackling novel quantitative methods to understand how exposure to historical racist policies in housing and urban planning has impacted health in a longitudinal cohort of older African American adults in Baltimore, MD.
- Funding: National Institute of Aging R01: "Examining Influences of Place-Based Long-Term and Contemporary Neighborhood Factors on Aging-Related Disease Risk Trajectories: Leveraging the HANDLS Dataset"

PI: Dr. Nadia N. Abuelezam, ScD

- Computational researcher employing political economics, human geography, sociology, and systems science frameworks to develop novel methods for quantifying mechanisms of health disparities.
- Led or co-authored 4 peer-reviewed scientific articles, 1 currently under review; have presented 5 projects at national conferences including two oral presentations.
- Serve as statistical analysis support for junior researchers.
- Funding: National Institute of General Medical Science R35 (terminated May 2025)

Communications & Research Assistant Sep 2022 to April 2023

University of Michigan, Housing Solutions for Health Equity Initiative

- Assist with conceptualization and oversee the initiative's social media, policy impact, and communication strategies. Maintain the initiative's website to include current content and update the website as needed.
- Create and design a newsletter to disseminate to our academic, policy, and community partners on the confluence of public health and housing policy.
- Create descriptive statistics tables and linear models; assist with literature reviews, manuscript writing, and editing.

Statistician Sep 2022 to Jan 2023

University of Michigan, STATCOM

- Worked with a small team of graduate students to create statistical models for the City of Detroit Housing Commission assessing the role rental assistance programs played in percentage of late rental payments for public housing tenants during the COVID-19 pandemic.
- Developed descriptive statistics tables and generalized linear models grouped by building to assess trends in tenant demographics and payment timing. Designed a brochure for preliminary findings.
- STATCOM is a community-facing student volunteer group that aims to help local nonprofits who need help solving complex statistical problems.

Graduate Research Assistant Jan 2020 to Aug 2021

University of Chicago, Linguistics Department

- As a graduate student research assistant, oversaw three multi-author editorial projects, comprising over 20 international experts on Slavic languages.
- Focused on post-Soviet language contact along Russian borders and socio-cultural implications.
- Managed peer review, formatting, copy editing, and English translations from Czech and Slovak.

ACADEMIC HONORS AND ACHIEVEMENT

Winner, Epidemiology Poster Session
University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, November 2022

- My poster, "Is residential racial segregation associated with epigenetic ageing?" was one of six winners selected at the University of Michigan Department of Epidemiology annual poster session, which features over 100 posters.

PUBLICATIONS

Fisher VP, Abuelezam NN. Quantitative Intersectionality Methods Are Not Theory-Neutral: A Population-level Example. Health Equity. *Under Review, May 2026.*

Fisher VP, Sadler RC, Abuelezam NN. A quantitative intersectional approach to measuring change in built environment amenities and the association with mortality in U.S. counties. *Social Science & Medicine*. 2026;400:119308. doi:10.1016/j.socscimed.2026.119308

- Role: project conception, data sourcing, analysis, main writing, editing.

Alkhouri NB, **Fisher VP**, Abuelezam NN. Equity in Wastewater Surveillance: Assessment of the National Wastewater Surveillance System for COVID-19. AJPM Focus. 10.1016/j.focus.2025.100434

- Role: Supported research design, statistical analysis, and developmental edits.

Fisher VP, Alkhouri N, Michel I, O'Connor C, Abuelezam NN. The impact of historical redlining policies on community composition and the COVID-19 pandemic in Boston. PLOS One. 20(6): e0324020. https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0324020

- Role: Co-first author (equal responsibility), led statistical analysis, developmental edits.

DeAngelis R, **Fisher VP**, Dou J, Bakulski K, Rigby D, Hicken M. Residential Segregation and Epigenetic Age Acceleration Among Older-Age Black and White Americans. *International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health*. 2025; 22(6):837. https://doi.org/10.3390/ijerph22060837

- Role: Original research for MPH thesis; developmental edits to manuscript iteration.

Fisher VP, Boretsky A, Alkhouri N, Abuelezam NN. Then and now: umbrella variables mask temporal mechanisms of structural racism in US urban environments. Critical Public Health. 2025;35(1):2492798. doi:10.1080/09581596.2025.2492798

- Role: First author; conceptualized, led statistical analysis, wrote manuscript.

Boretsky A, **Fisher VP**, Abuelezam NN. Intersectionality of sex and race in COVID-19 mortality and vaccination inequities in Massachusetts. BMC Public Health. 2024;24(1):2987. Published 2024 Oct 29. doi:10.1186/s12889-024-20340-z

- Role: Guided statistical analysis and developmental editing.

PRESENTATIONS & INTERVIEWS

2026 International Medical Geography Symposium
Toronto, Ont, CA, July 2026
Panel presentation (session chair): "Sprawling Out: Considering Additional Metropolitan Characteristics" in the session: The Built Environment and Urban Form

2026 Geographies of Aging (GOAL) Symposium
Tallahassee, FL, Feb 2026

Oral presentation: "Statistical challenges of measuring Historical and Contemporary Exposures to Urban Development Practices Driving Premature Aging"

2025 Society for Epidemiologic Research Annual Meeting
Boston, MA, June 2025
Panel presentation: "Historical Political Economics for Population Health Research" in the "What's in a place? Incorporating place-based context into intersectional epidemiology research on health disparities" session.
Oral Abstract Presentation: "Extending Intersectional Methods to Population Health Research" in the "Methods: Definitions, Approaches, and Challenges" session.

2025 Health Academy Annual Research Meeting (accepted, not presented)
Minneapolis, MN, June 2025
Poster presentation: "Understanding Structural Determinants of Health and U.S. County COVID-19 Mortality: A Novel Intersectional Methodology"

2024 Academy Health Annual Research Meeting
Baltimore, MD, July 2024
Poster presentation: "Delineating mechanisms of structural racism by time: excess all-cause mortality in Kansas City, 2020 - 2021"

2024 Society for Epidemiologic Research Annual Meeting
Austin, TX, June 2024
Poster presentation: "Trends in Tuberculosis: Geographic changes in TB prevalence among US-Born cases, 2016 - 2022"
Poster presentation: "Historical disenfranchisement, contemporary disadvantage, and excess all-cause mortality in Kansas City, 2020 – 2021"

Speaking of Alzheimer's – Alzheimer's Association New England
May 2024
Podcast episode: "Shaping the Future of the Ageing & Dementia Workforce"

Epidemiology Department Poster Session
University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, November 2022
Poster presentation "Is residential racial segregation associated with epigenetic ageing?"

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant Practicum, Epidemiology Dept. Aug 2026 to April 2027
University of Pittsburgh

- Principles of Epidemiology: Dr. Thomas Songer
  - Fall 2026
  - Requires 1-hour of instruction in front of students (124 students)
  - Developed a 2-page teaching philosophy statement
- Foundations of Epidemiology: Dr. Megan Marron
  - Spring 2027
  - Contribution to homework and exam question creation
  - Teaching in front of students (100+)

Graduate Student Instructor, Public Health Sept 2022 to Dec 2022
University of Michigan, Ann Arbor

- Assisted Dr. Victor Strecher with 'Social and Behavioral Foundations of Public Health', an undergraduate course averaging 50 students per semester.
- Independently created lesson plans and taught two discussion sections of approximately 25 students each.

PROFESSIONAL TRAINING

School of Public Health Summer Session
University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, July 2022
Course: Spatial Statistics for Epidemiology—a one-week intensive course on spatial epidemiological methods in R.

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Gerontological Society of America 2025 – Present
Early Career Member

Society for Epidemiologic Research 2024 - Present
Early Career Member

Network for Innovative Methods in Longitudinal Ageing Studies 2022 - Present
Working Group: The creation of high-quality longitudinal data for ageing minority populations

SKILLS

Programming: R (proficient), Python (learning), SAS (familiar), HTML/CSS (intermediate)
Research: Study design, advanced statistical methods (hierarchical models, Bayesian models, time-series analysis, dimension-reduction techniques), project management, literature review, science writing & editing, real-world data analysis
Languages: English (native), French – B1, Spanish – A2/B1, German – A2/B1

WORK EXPERIENCE

Communications Specialist, Center for Social Solutions Sept 2020 to Sept 2022
University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI

- Oversaw all strategic communications efforts for the racial and social justice research center, including thought leadership, editorial calendar development, fundraising initiatives, PR, branding, social media, website management, and event production.
- Managed the multi-team research website development project; identified stages, delegated duties, designed feedback strategies, presented products to leadership.
- Interviewed, hired, and delegated to undergraduate and graduate communications assistants.

Marketing Associate Feb 2020 to Aug 2020
Opportunity International, Chicago, IL

- Developed communication collateral including capital campaigns, event invitations, presentations, brochures and social media fodder.
- Contributed to fundraising event production that raised over $500,000.
- Managed contact database, expense reports, and website inquiries.

Communications Coordinator May 2019 to Jan 2020
Skidmore Owings & Merrill, Chicago, IL

- Supported firm-wide and local communications managers in the advancement of strategic communications initiatives, including the creation of project storytelling, narratives, white paper development, and award submissions.
- In-house videographer and producer, copyright manager.
- Press relations and press monitoring.

Communications Coordinator June 2017 to April 2019
Sasaki, Watertown, MA

- Communications coordinator specializing in multimedia content production.
- Developed thought leadership and areas of focus for the firm's editorial calendar; ghostwrote for practice leadership.
- Co-managed communications interns and assistants.